Mountains

Mountains form over millions of years when huge plates of Earth's crust push against each other. Mount Everest in the Himalayas is the highest mountain above sea level, at 8,849 metres. The higher you climb, the thinner the air becomes, so many climbers on the tallest peaks carry bottled oxygen. On average, the temperature drops by about 6.5 degrees Celsius for every 1,000 metres you go up. Many great rivers, such as the Ganges, begin as melting snow and glaciers high in the mountains.